

YOUR HOUSING OPTIONS IN ATLANTA COMPARED, HONESTLY

For adults on a fixed income — what each option actually costs and involves

There's more than one way to find housing on a fixed income. Here's a straight comparison of the real options, so you can make the choice that's right for you.

1. RENTING ON YOUR OWN (MARKET RATE)

Option	Pros	Cons
Average studio: ~\$1,450/mo rent + \$150–250 utilities + \$1,450 deposit upfront	Your own private space, full independence, your name on the lease	Requires credit check, large upfront cost, no built-in community or support, you handle everything alone

2. SUBSIDIZED & PUBLIC HOUSING PROGRAMS

These federal programs generally cap what you pay at about 30% of your monthly income, with the government covering the rest:

- Housing Choice Voucher Program (Section 8) — administered locally by the Atlanta Housing Authority
- Public Housing — government-owned units managed directly by the local housing authority
- Project-Based Rental Assistance — subsidy tied to a specific building or unit
- Section 811 Supportive Housing for Persons with Disabilities — HUD program for disabled adults

Option	Pros	Cons
Rent capped near 30% of your income	The lowest possible rent by far — often just a fraction of what market rate costs	Waitlists that can run for years — some close entirely; once you're in, your safety depends on how well that specific building is run, and plenty aren't run well: residents in troubled units describe broken elevators and AC for months, roaches and rats they can't get rid of, hallways where drug activity and prostitution happen in plain sight, and crime rates high enough that people are afraid to walk to their own door at night. You don't get to pick your building. You get whatever opens up.

Being honest: subsidized housing is a real, valid option, and rent is genuinely the lowest you'll find anywhere. But the quality of your actual day-to-day life there is a dice roll — entirely dependent on how well that one building happens to be managed, and you won't know which building you're getting until you're already in it.

3. PADSPLIT

Option	Pros	Cons
\$175–450/week (~\$758–1,950/mo) + \$100 membership fee + ~\$100 move-in fee	No security deposit, no minimum credit score, furniture + utilities + WiFi included, move in fast	Requires an identity and background check, \$100 membership + ~\$100 move-in fee on top of rent, 12-week minimum stay with a penalty for leaving early, no in-person tour before move-in (3D tours only), no on-site community or accountability structure

★ A LAUNCH PAD FOR GROWTH ★

NEW CREATION LIVING

\$775/month, flat. Everything included. Nothing hidden.

✓ No security deposit ✓ No credit check ✓ No membership fee ✓ No move-in fee	✓ Furnished room, utilities, WiFi, laundry — all included ✓ A real house manager on-site, every day ✓ A points system that pays YOU — free rent, gift cards, and more ✓ An actual community, not just a roof ✓ NA/AA meeting resources ✓ Work, volunteer & school resources ✓ A financial growth course ✓ A sober, drug-free environment
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The one honest tradeoff: shared living — roommate-style rooms, not a private unit.

THE HONEST BOTTOM LINE

If you qualify for subsidized housing and can wait out the waitlist, it's the cheapest option that exists — we won't tell you otherwise. If you need something now, PadSplit is a solid model, but it comes with its own fees and a 12-week commitment. New Creation Living provides more than just housing. It is a launch pad for growth: a flat, predictable rate with nothing extra tacked on, real people on-site, and a system built to help you build something, not just pay rent.

Ready to see if a room is open?
newcreationliving.org

New Creation Living | Atlanta, GA | "From Benefits to Belonging"

Figures are current as of 2026 and sourced from HUD.gov, the Social Security Administration, and PadSplit's published pricing. Program availability, waitlists, and pricing can change — always confirm current details directly with each provider.